



Mathias 38

38-year-old patient, married, father of a three-year-old daughter, employed for 22 years as a steel worker in an iron foundry, currently unable to work for the past 12 months. Since the sudden death of his mother 20 years ago, he has experienced recurrent depressive episodes. Eleven years ago, he attempted suicide in the context of alcohol consumption following separation from his first wife. He is currently facing a stressful psychosocial situation characterized by financial worries, child support obligations for two children from his first marriage, ongoing conflicts with his ex-wife, and fear of losing contact with his children. He is socially withdrawn and lacks a circle of friends. The current rehabilitation program is experienced by the patient as an opportunity to receive support and develop new occupational perspectives. For approximately 10 years, the patient has suffered from chronic back pain. Five years ago, he experienced a herniated disc at L4/5 and L5/S1. Currently, he reports predominantly left-sided lumbar radicular pain with radiation to the knee joint, as well as pain exacerbation under psychological stress. Physical limitations are particularly evident when lifting and carrying heavy loads, during prolonged sitting or standing, and when bending forward. Pharmacological treatment with a tricyclic antidepressant and an opioid has resulted in partial pain reduction. Psychopathological findings reveal a pronounced depressive syndrome with depressed mood, lack of drive, fatigue, reduced enjoyment of life, sleep disturbances, impaired concentration and attention, and recurrent suicidal ideation. In addition, there is marked insecurity, distrust toward others, heightened sensitivity to criticism, and impulsive aggressive outbursts associated with significant interpersonal conflicts in both private and occupational settings. Previous psychotherapeutic treatments were experienced by the patient as not particularly helpful.

Diagnoses: F33.1 Recurrent depressive disorder, current episode moderate, F61.0 Mixed personality disorder, F45.41 Chronic pain disorder with somatic and psychological factors, M54.4 Left-sided lumboschialgia, Status post herniated disc at L4/5 and L5/S1

Symptoms: persistent depressed mood, loss of drive, social isolation, sleep disturbances, reduced stress tolerance, concentration difficulties, recurrent suicidal thoughts, impulsive aggressive outbursts, distrust, increased sensitivity to criticism, as well as chronic pain with significant physical functional impairment.